Persist Week of February 9, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Condition 5x

- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Condition 4x
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Condition 3x
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Perform
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026
- Saturday February 14, 2026
- Sunday February 15, 2026

Minimalist
- Monday February 9, 2026
- Tuesday February 10, 2026
- Wednesday February 11, 2026
- Thursday February 12, 2026
- Friday February 13, 2026

Saturday February 14, 2026
Sunday February 15, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM (1 Rep Max). It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Pull Up Negative; 3 reps @51A1 (see loading note)
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Weight may be added for the GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hyper, but aim to keep the technique perfect and tempo controlled. If you do not have access to either of these, you may perform the 45-degree alternative in the exercises swap section.
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the Pull Up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a Pull Up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

F) Finisher (8 min):
8 min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
10 Crush Grip DB Bicep Curl
30m DB Crush Grip Bicep Curl Carry
30m Farmers Walk
*Every 10m of the Farmers Walk, perform 5 DB Shrugs.
Loading Note:
For the DB Curl, select a weight that you can perform for a max set of about 20 reps. For the Farmers Walk, use a weight that you can perform for a max set of 100m.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch

Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you'll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Band Pullapart; 20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Skullcrusher; 10 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Hands on Bench Narrow Grip Push Up; BW reps to failure (aiming for 10+ reps)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Suitcase Front Foot Elevated KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets

Bicycle Crunch; 30-40 reps (15-20/side)
Heel Taps; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)
Russian Twist; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Pronated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Intensity Giant Set
Today's giant set is a combination of lower body exercises that are each manageable on their own. But when you combine them, they offer a strong, yet safe stimulus for the lower body.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single DB Sumo RDL; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Ring Assisted Pistol Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the ring assisted Pistol Squat, you can hold onto any object that will act as a counterbalance and upper body support to keep the movement controlled and high quality. Perform a few reps of each movement to determine starting set up. Aim for each set to be RPE 8+. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 15 sec
Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you’ll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Band Pullapart; 20 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (Drop back to same weight as Set 1)
Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Skullcrusher; 10 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Hands on Bench Narrow Grip Push Up; BW reps to failure (aiming for 10+ reps)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side

Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM (1 Rep Max). It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).
Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Increase weight each set.

Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets

Goblet Squat; 10 reps @22X1

rest 30 sec

DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side

rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side

rest 15 sec

Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side

Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side

Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Ankles and Wrists

Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Push up; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Pronated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:

The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.
Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension.

Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Suitcase Front Foot Elevated KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bicycle Crunch; 30-40 reps (15-20/side)
Heel Taps; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)
Russian Twist; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)
rest 90 sec between sets

Loading Note:

*Minimal rest between exercises.

Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
20 min Full Body
Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps
Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot "enough"? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min): Week 1
Sumo Deadlift

5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8

Loading Note:

In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM (1 Rep Max). It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Squat; 10 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bicycle Crunch; 30-40 reps (15-20/side)
Heel Taps; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)
Russian Twist; 20-30 reps (10-15/side)

rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Push up; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
20 min Full Body
Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps
Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets

Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Pronated Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 15 sec
Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you

will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Pull Up Negative; 4 reps @51A1 (see loading note)
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Weight may be added for the GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree hyper, but aim to keep the technique perfect and tempo controlled. If you do not have access to either of these, you may perform the 45-degree alternative in the exercises swap section.
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the Pull Up bar, so you can step or jump back up to

the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a Pull Up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
1000/800m Bike Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....(add 2 reps each round)
Alternating KB Gorilla Row (R+L=1) 53/35# or 35/26#
KB Plank Pull Through 53/35# or 35/26#
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would choose for an 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you'll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Band Pullapart; 20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4 (16-12-10-8-4 female cals)
Row Cals
20-16-12-8-4
Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmers Walk between rounds
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements. For women, only the row calorie targets are different in this workout (to account for differences in power output).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Alternating Single Arm Devils Press 50/35# (male/female)
6 Right Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
6 Left Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
200-250m Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with lighter weights or the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side

Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
10-12 DB Z Press @ 20X0
Bike 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m KB Rack Carry TOUGH
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Intensity Giant Set
Today's giant set is a combination of lower body exercises that are each manageable on their own. But when you combine them, they offer a strong, yet safe stimulus for the lower body.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single DB Sumo RDL; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Rounds For Time
30/25 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Air Squat
30 Feet Anchored Sit Up
60 Double Unders or 80 Single Unders
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning

our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you’ll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Band Pullapart; 20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4 (16-12-10-8-4 female cals)
Row Cals
20-16-12-8-4
Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmers Walk between rounds
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements. For women, only the row calorie targets are different in this workout (to account for differences in power output).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression

While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Squat; 10 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Rounds For Time
30/25 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Air Squat
30 Feet Anchored Sit Up
60 Double Unders or 80 Single Unders
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
10-12 DB Z Press @ 20X0

Bike 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m KB Rack Carry TOUGH
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Alternating Single Arm Devils Press 50/35# (male/female)
6 Right Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
6 Left Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
200-250m Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with lighter weights or the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):

250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
20 min Full Body
Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps
Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for

all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Half Kneeling Landmine Press; 8 reps/side @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Rounds For Time
30/25 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Air Squat
30 Feet Anchored Sit Up
60 Double Unders or 80 Single Unders
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench for Triceps
The Bench Press is often viewed as a chest exercise, but happens to be one of the best tricep exercises you can do. The Triceps are forced to go through a large range of motion with a lot of weight, even while being supported by the pecs. The Close-Grip Bench Press is a subtle variation that forces even a little more tricep and less chest. Place your hands straight out from your shoulders, as if you were imitating a zombie.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Push up; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Squat; 10 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
10-12 DB Z Press @ 20X0
Bike 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m KB Rack Carry TOUGH
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
20 min Full Body
Neck Circles x 3 reps/side

Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Yoga Pushup x 5 reps
Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Alternating Single Arm Devils Press 50/35# (male/female)
8 Right Arm DB Push Press
8 Left Arm DB Push Press
200-250m Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with lighter weights or the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):

250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: The Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. So during this progression, you will see the Sumo Deadlift transition through 3 different rep schemes (5x5, 6x3, and 8x2). Each of these rep schemes are structured to keep reps high quality but not take you to absolute max. Sometimes leaving a bit in the tank is a smart approach for the future.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
15/12 Calorie Row (male/female)
16 Kettlebell Switch Snatch 53/35 or 35/26 - 8/arm
16 Bodyweight Walking Lunges
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min): Sumo Deadlift
5 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-5: 5 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:

In the classic 5x5 rep scheme, the weight selected should be about 75% of your 1RM. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 25 reps. The goal is not to build to a 5 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 5 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Pull Up Negative; 4 reps @51A1 (see loading note)
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Weight may be added for the GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree hyper, but aim to keep the technique perfect and tempo controlled. If you do not have access to either of these, you may perform the 45-degree alternative in the exercises swap section.
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the pull up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a pull up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
1000/800m Bike Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
24 Double Unders
8 Power Snatch (75/55#)
2 Bar Muscle Up
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would choose for an 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side

Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you'll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Landmine Press, Filly Press, and Strict Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Band Pullapart; 20 reps

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets
Dip Support; 20-30 sec
directly into
Dip Support Knee Tucks; 10-15 reps
rest 15sec
DB External Rotation on Knee; 12-15 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Start on the lower end of the rep or seconds range. If you feel good then increase effort with each set by going higher rep, longer, or more weight.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min): Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (12-15 min):
3:30 AMRAP (As Many Row Cals As Possible) x 3 Sets:
Buy In:
18-15-12
18 DB Bench Press (50/35#) (male/female)
30m/side Single Arm Farmer Carry
15 DB Bench Press
30m/side Single Arm Farmer Carry
12 DB Bench Press
*Then in remaining time:
Row as many Calories as Possible
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Use lighter weights if you need more time to row. Try to leave yourself about 60-90 seconds of rowing each round.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Back Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Curtsy Squat; 10 reps/side
Theraband Glute Bridge; 15-20 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Low Hang Snatch High Pull + 1 Low Hang Power Snatch + 1 Hang Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Rounds For Time
30/25 Cal Row (male/female)
30 Jump Lunge (15/side)
20 Toes to Bar
10 Burpee Box Jump Step Down
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog

then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
Every 2:30 x 4 sets
5 Strict Handstand Push Up or 5 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
10 Alternating DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/25# (male/female)

10/8 Cal Bike @ HIGH Effort
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
20/16 Calorie Bike (male/female)
6 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
100m KB Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
100m KB Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
20/16 Calorie Bike
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note: These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Intensity Giant Set
Today's giant set is a combination of lower body exercises that are each manageable on their own. But when you combine them, they offer a strong, yet safe stimulus for the lower body.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
1 Hang Clean + 1 Front Squat + 1 Hang Clean + 1 Front Squat
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
Goblet Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec
Single DB Sumo RDL; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 Sets
A. 15 American KBS 53/35# (male/female)
B. 15 Box Jump Overs 24/20"
C. 15-20 Cal Bike
D. 15 Burpees
E. 15 Wall Balls 20/14# to 10'
rest walk 2mins
Effort Note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA
Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning

our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday February 9, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Vertical Pressing
Throughout this training cycle, you’ll see three different vertical pressing movements: the Half Kneeling DB Press, Filly Press, and DB Push Press. Each one explores different parts of the shoulder - keeping this movement pattern fresh, while avoiding overuse.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
1/2 Turkish Get Up; 5 reps/side
Prone Half Angels; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Half Kneeling DB Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Incline DB Chest Fly; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4 (16-12-10-8-4 female cals)
Hanging Knee Tuck
*8 Burpee + 30m Farmers Walk between rounds
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Tuesday February 10, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: The DB Sumo Deadlift Progression
While effort is extremely important to progress, reaching a 10/10 is not always needed, especially on lifts that can aggravate those with past injuries or nagging pain. The DB Sumo Deadlift is a

great exercise to challenge the posterior chain, but leave reps in reserve to assure you can maintain great positions for all sets.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Renegade Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): DB Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The tempo prescription for today has a brief pause in the bottom position, emphasizing the control in the most challenging part of the lift.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Goblet Squat; 10 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Zercher Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Rounds For Time
400m Run
30 Air Squat
30 Feet Anchored Sit Up
60 Double Unders or 80 Single Unders
*20 min time cap.

Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday February 11, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday February 12, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The DB Floor Press and DB Narrow Grip Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Ring Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Narrow Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max reps of Narrow Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
DB Skull Crushers; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 10 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
12min Continuous Clock
5 Shuttle Run
8-12 Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm DB Power Clean 50/35# or 35/20#
10 Left Arm DB Power Clean 50/35# or 35/20#
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side

Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday February 13, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bottom of the Squat
In this 6 week training block, you'll see both Pause and 1 1/4 Squats. These two exercises will really work your bottom position of the squat. Keep working on improving the quality and control of the bottom of your squat in this cycle - it is great not only for strength, but for mobility as well. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For this tempo, you'll take 2 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 2 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Hip Thrust; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Alternating Single Arm Devils Press 50/35# (male/female)
6 Right Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
6 Left Leg Goblet Kickstand Squat 50/35#
Run 150m
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with lighter weights or the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday February 14, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work:
40 min total work
Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat
Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
20 min Full Body
Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday February 15, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST
Enough is Enough

One of the hardest skills to develop as an athlete is knowing when enough is ENOUGH. Most of us were trained to believe that effort only counts if it hurts us, exhausts us, or leaves us questioning our choices in life. But longevity in training means riding the waves of effort and recovery, so you feel like coming back again.

On any given day, the goal is applying the right amount of stress for where your body actually is. That might mean pushing more and even challenging your self-inflicted limits on days you feel fresh. And it might mean holding back on days where sleep, stress, or life have already taken a toll. Both are productive in the long run.

Where in your training do you tend to overshoot “enough”? What would it look like to stop just a small bit earlier this week?

With love,
Marcus